

PM Planning with Adam (04/17/2026)

News for Today

- FOMC Member Daly Speaks (11:30AM)
 - FOMC Member Barkin Speaks (12:15PM)
 - Fed Waller Speaks (2:00PM)
 - Netflix: shares dropped sharply after weaker-than-expected revenue growth projections and news that Chairman Reed Hastings will not seek re-election
 - Alcoa: moved lower after missing on profit and revenue, with higher costs and softer demand weighing on results
 - Autoliv: jumped after reporting stronger-than-expected quarterly results
 - Clorox: edged lower after JPMorgan Chase downgraded the stock to “underweight,” citing increased competition from private-label products
 - NiSource: climbed after announcing a long-term energy deal tied to a data center project with a subsidiary of Alphabet
 - Onto Innovation: surged after an upgrade to “buy” from Stifel, following strong preliminary revenue results
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 Market Overview — Friday, April 17, 2026 U.S. Futures Rise as Rally Extends on Middle East Optimism

U.S. stock futures moved higher Friday morning, pointing to a continuation of this week's rally as improving sentiment around Middle East tensions and steady earnings continue to support risk appetite.

- Dow futures: +161 pts (+0.3%)
- S&P 500 futures: +17 pts (+0.2%)
- Nasdaq futures: +53 pts (+0.2%)

All three major indexes are now on track to close the week with gains, following fresh record highs in both the S&P 500 and Nasdaq in the previous session.

 De-escalation hopes continue to drive sentiment

Markets are continuing to react positively to signs of easing tensions in the Middle East. A pause in fighting between Israel and Lebanon, along with renewed expectations for U.S.-Iran negotiations, has helped reinforce the idea that the conflict may not escalate further.

President Donald Trump indicated that talks with Iran could resume as soon as this weekend, and noted that both sides are "very close" to reaching an agreement. He also suggested a ceasefire extension could be considered if progress continues.

This shift toward de-escalation has been a key driver behind the recent rally, with investors increasingly positioning for a more stable geopolitical backdrop.



 Tech and AI stocks regain momentum

With geopolitical fears easing, attention has rotated back into the tech sector, particularly names tied to artificial intelligence.

Companies involved in AI hardware have been among the standout performers:

- Intel
- Micron Technology
- SanDisk

This comes after a pullback earlier in the year tied to concerns over disruption from emerging AI technologies. The rebound suggests renewed confidence in the longer-term AI growth narrative.

 Oil pulls back but remains elevated

Oil prices declined following the de-escalation headlines, though they remain well above pre-war levels and just under the \$100 mark.

While easing tensions have reduced immediate supply fears, ongoing factors such as partial disruptions through the Strait of Hormuz and continued U.S. pressure on Iranian exports are still keeping prices elevated.

At the same time, both the International Energy Agency and OPEC have warned of softer demand ahead, adding another layer of complexity to the oil outlook.



Earnings remain supportive, but mixed reactions

Corporate earnings continue to play a key role in market direction, with results broadly reinforcing the idea of a resilient economy. Bank executives have largely pointed to stable consumer activity despite higher energy costs.

However, individual stock reactions have been mixed:

- Netflix fell premarket after issuing weaker-than-expected revenue guidance and announcing that Chairman Reed Hastings will not seek re-election
 - Alcoa declined after missing expectations due to higher costs and softer demand
 - Autoliv moved higher after posting stronger-than-expected results
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Fed speakers in focus

With the economic calendar relatively light, attention may shift toward commentary from Federal Reserve officials, including:

- Mary Daly (San Francisco Fed)
- Tom Barkin (Richmond Fed)
- Christopher Waller (Fed Governor)

Any signals around inflation or rate expectations could influence market direction into the end of the week.



⚠ Breakdown: what's driving the market now?

- De-escalation in the Middle East = primary tailwind
- Tech + AI strength = leading the rally
- Earnings = supportive but selective
- Oil = easing slightly, still elevated

The overall tone remains risk-on, with improving sentiment continuing to support equities.

👁 What traders are watching today

- Headlines around U.S.-Iran negotiations
 - Continued movement in AI-related stocks
 - Reactions to earnings (especially follow-through)
 - Fed speaker commentary
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🔍 Adam's Watchlist

- \$QQQ: Looking to go long off the 645's KL for a push up into the 650's KL. If we break below, I'll be going short off the 643's KL for a push down into the 640's KL and potentially the 637's KL.
- \$AAPL: Looking to go long off the 267.70's KL for a push up into the 271.85's KL and potentially the 274's KL.
- \$PDD: Looking to go long off the 108.07's KL for a push up into the 110.30's KL and potentially the 113.45's KL.

- \$BABA: Looking to go long off the 141.85's KL for a push up into the 143.15's KL and potentially the 149.19's KL.
 - \$NFLX: Looking to go long off the 97.45's KL for a push up into the 100.18's KL and potentially the 103.24's KL.
 - \$ALV: Looking to go long off the 124.34's KL for a push up into the 126.79's KL and potentially the 130.14's KL.
 - \$MSTR: Looking to go long off the 152.31's KL for a push up into the 156.37's KL and potentially the 160.37's KL.
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⚡ COMMUNITY WATCHLIST ⚡

- \$ORCL: Looking to go long off the 184.92's KL for a push up into the 195's KL.
 - \$TSM: Looking to go long off the 374.24's KL for a push up into the 376.09's KL and potentially the 380's/385's KL.
 - \$ONTO: Looking to go long off the 288.17's KL for a push up into the 300's KL.
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